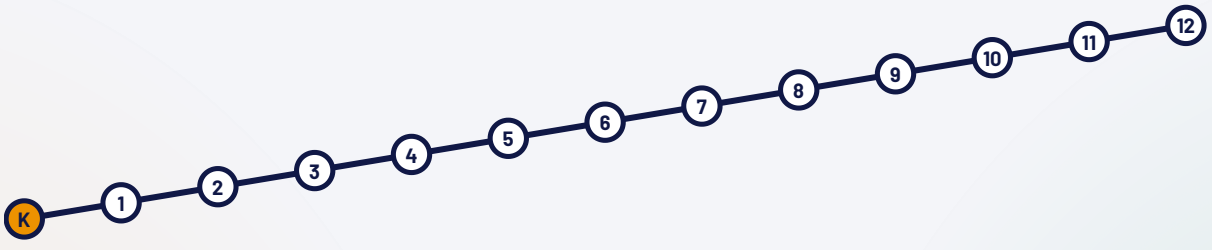
Awsaj Academy

K-12 VERTICAL ALIGNMENT · AN ANALYTICAL WALKTHROUGH

Our Curriculum Journey: K–5

What our teachers' ratings tell us about how our standards are taught, from Kindergarten to Grade 12, with questions and options for our part in the story.



These findings come from the ratings you entered as teachers. They show what teachers reported as taught across each grade (2,709 ratings, completed November 2026), not what students know or can do, and they do not judge any teacher. Every item links to the data on the Vertical Alignment site.

Contents

1	**Elementary, K-5** Kindergarten to Grade 5, all four subjects.	3
2	**About the data (at the back)** Where the data comes from, how to read the ratings, the words we use, and the limits.	15

Each part follows the same path: the picture (charts), what the numbers say, what we notice, questions for us, and our part in the story (options for improving the curriculum, working across grade levels, knowing the bands above and below, and a concrete action). The data behind each item is shown in brackets, and each item links to the matching page of the Vertical Alignment site. About the data (where the data comes from, how to read the ratings, the words we use and the limits) is at the back. 18 pages, A4. The bookmarks jump to each part.

Taught in depth Introduced / exposed Not taught

ELEMENTARY, KINDERGARTEN TO GRADE 5

Elementary, K-5

In K-5, teachers reported that 63% of the 700 grade-level ratings are at least introduced, and 21% are taught in depth. Grade 2 has the highest share in depth of any grade, and Math and Science lead the band at 29% each.

21%	63%	37%	700
taught in depth	at least introduced	not taught	grade-level ratings

What you are seeing. Four headline figures for this part: the share taught in depth, at least introduced and not taught, and how many ratings they come from.

What it adds to our story. This is the starting picture for this part. The slides that follow show where these numbers come from and what they might mean for us.

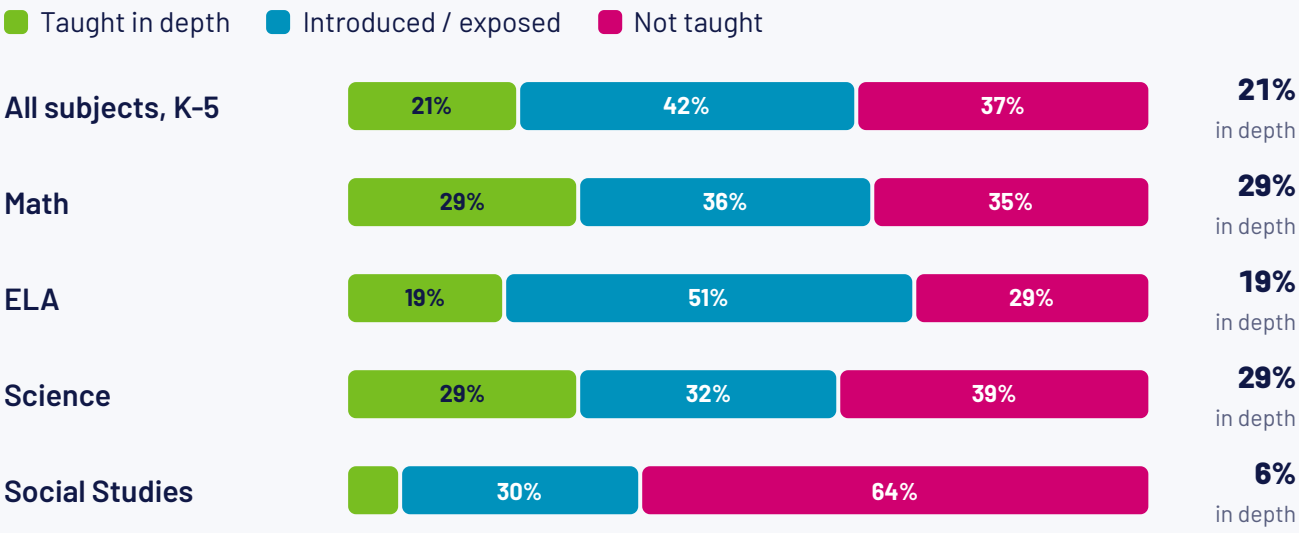
These findings come from the ratings you entered as teachers. They show what teachers reported as taught across each grade, not what students know or can do. We are sharing them back so we can see the whole picture together and decide how we move forward. Each part ends with options for our part in the story. Every item links to the data on the Vertical Alignment site.

THE PICTURE

At a glance

What you are seeing. Each bar shows all the ratings for one subject: green is taught in depth, blue is introduced, pink is not taught.

What it adds to our story. K-5 introduces widely. Math and Science go deepest, and Social Studies is mostly rated not taught.



How to read this: each bar is 100% of the grade-level ratings. Green is taught in depth, blue is introduced or exposed, pink is not taught. Essential Elements are counted apart.

Open the coverage map on the site ↗

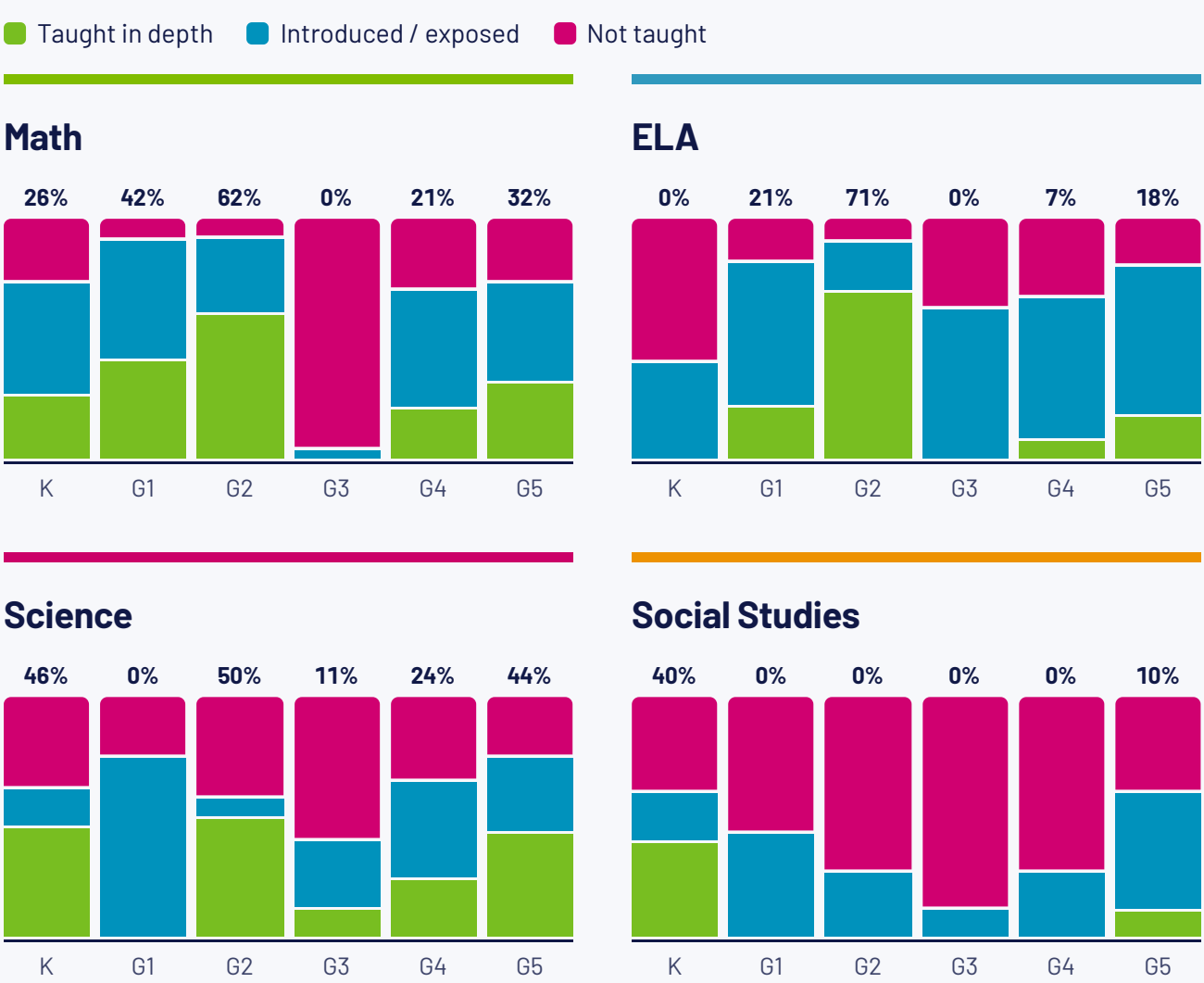
Share in depth	K	G1	G2	G3	G4	G5	K-5
Math	26%	42%	62%	0%	21%	32%	29%
ELA	0%	21%	71%	0%	7%	18%	19%
Science	46%	0%	50%	11%	24%	44%	29%
Social Studies	40%	0%	0%	0%	0%	10%	6%
All subjects	16%	21%	55%	2%	12%	24%	21%

THE PICTURE

Grade by grade

What you are seeing. One column for each grade. The number on top is the share of that grade's standards taught in depth.

What it adds to our story. Grade 2 shows how deep teaching can go. The grades around it rated far fewer standards in depth, which is worth talking about together.

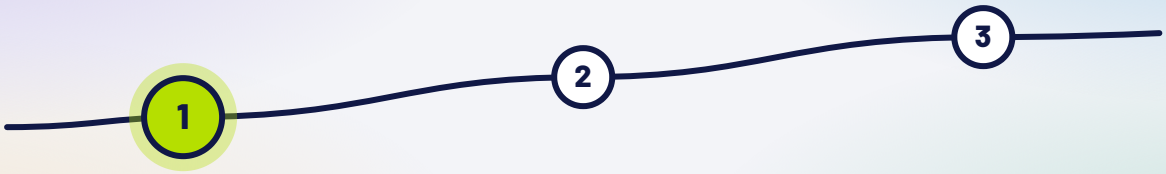


How to read this: for each subject, one column per grade, with the share taught in depth on top.

Open the grade dashboards ↗ Gaps and repetition ↗ Progressions ↗

K-5 · OUR CURRICULUM JOURNEY

Section 1: Facts



SECTION 1 OF 3

Facts

What you are seeing. The main facts from the ratings, in plain numbers. Each one links to the data on the Vertical Alignment site.

What it adds to our story. The foundations are strongest in number (place value). Fractions, Language and Social Studies are the thinner threads.

Bright spots

Where teaching is strongest.

1. **Grade 2 has the most in depth.** 55% in depth across all subjects: ELA 71%, Math 62%, Science 50%. Grade 2 dashboard ↗
2. **Place value is our strongest Math strand.** 60% of Number and Operations in Base Ten ratings are in depth, including every Grade 2 standard. Grade 2 dashboard ↗

Gaps

Standards rated not taught by the grade they belong to, or where they were placed.

3. **Fractions are the thinnest Math strand.** None of the 30 fractions ratings in Grades 3 to 5 is in depth, and 63% are not taught. Coverage map ↗
4. **Social Studies.** 64% of ratings are not taught. Only Kindergarten (40%) and Grade 5 (10%) have anything in depth. A further 24 Social Studies standards are rated not taught in the grade where they fit best. Gaps and repetition ↗
5. **Progressions.** 39 of 109 K-5 progressions break down on an official link. 18 are taught at every step, 11 of them in Science. Progressions ↗
6. **Standards not taught in their own grade.** 222 in K-5: ELA 100, Math 60, Social Studies 38, Science 24. Gaps and repetition ↗

Breadth without depth

Standards introduced widely but rarely taken to depth.

7. **Grade 1 introduces the most.** 78% of Grade 1 standards are at least introduced, the highest of any grade K-12. Coverage map ↗

8. **Introduced, never in depth.** 294 standards are introduced and never in depth: ELA 174, Math 63, Social Studies 29, Science 28. Gaps and repetition ↗

Anomalies

Results that stand out and are worth a second look.

9. **Power lists.** Kindergarten names 47 of its 57 ELA standards as power standards, and Grade 3 rates 17 of its 18 Math power standards not taught. Priority and power (Audit) ↗

10. **Grade 3 rated differently.** 2% in depth and 63% not taught. In Math, 31 of 32 standards are rated not taught. Grade 3 dashboard ↗

Other notable

Other facts worth knowing.

11. **The band in 3 numbers.** 148 ratings in depth (21%), 295 introduced (42%), 257 not taught (37%). Coverage map ↗

12. **By subject.** Math 29% in depth, Science 29%, ELA 19%, Social Studies 6%. Coverage map ↗

13. **ELA strands.** Reading Foundational Skills and Speaking and Listening are at 25% in depth, Reading 24%, Writing 22%, Language 10%. Coverage map ↗

14. **Science strands.** Life Science 47% in depth, Physical Science 31%, Earth and Space 25%, Engineering 11%. Coverage map ↗

15. **Power standards.** 20% of power standard ratings are in depth and 37% are not taught, level with all standards (21%). Priority and power (Audit) ↗

16. **Essential Elements.** 56% in depth: Math 82%, ELA 46%. K-5 Science and Social Studies use AERO and have no Essential Elements. Coverage map ↗



SECTION 2 OF 3

Patterns

What you are seeing. What we notice when we put the facts side by side: rises, dips and comparisons. These are possibilities to talk about, not conclusions.

What it adds to our story. Much deep teaching in K-5 may happen at the level students are at (the Essential Elements), which the main ratings do not show.

Trends across the grades

How things rise, fall or alternate from grade to grade.

1. **Social Studies starts well and fades.** Kindergarten has 40% in depth. Grades 1 to 4 rated none of their Social Studies standards in depth, and Grades 2, 3 and 4 rate 73% to 89% not taught, perhaps because much of that time goes to literacy. Kindergarten dashboard ↗

2. **Science depth alternates by year.** In depth by grade: 46%, 0%, 50%, 11%, 24%, 44%. Coverage does not alternate: Grade 1 introduces 75% of its Science standards. One possible reason is that each year runs different units. Grade 1 dashboard ↗

3. **K-2 builds; Grade 3 rated very differently.** Depth climbs from 16% in Kindergarten to 21% and 55%, is 2% in Grade 3 (a grade that rated most of its Essential Elements in depth), and rebuilds to 12% and 24%. The Grade 3 dip appears in Math, ELA and Science. Coverage map ↗

Handoffs

What passes between grades and between schools.

4. **Number is strong, and the path beyond number is thin.** Place value reaches 60% in depth. Operations and Algebraic Thinking (23%, with 43% not taught), Measurement and Data (23%) and Fractions (0%) are the strands that lead into middle school Math. Coverage map ↗

5. **Physical Science in K-5 matters later.** Twelve K-5 Physical Science standards are rated not taught by their own grade. Nine of the 17 Science hand-over gaps, all on suggested links, start here and feed Grade 8 and Grade 10 Physical Science, which are among our strongest results. Progressions ↗

6. **Six Math progressions break down.** Counting, place value, addition and subtraction, multiplication and division, measurement, and area and volume each have a step taught in depth above a step rated not taught. Progressions ↗

7. **Depth shifts by subject at the hand-over to Grade 6.** 34 hand-over gaps begin in K-5 (Science 17, ELA 12, Social Studies 5). From Grade 5 to Grade 6, Math goes from 32% to 0%, ELA from 18% to 40%, Science from 44% to 24%. Progressions ↗

Language and literacy

Where language and literacy are taught, and how.

8. **Kindergarten introduces widely in Math and Science but not yet in ELA.** Kindergarten rated none of its ELA standards in depth, and 93% of its Language standards are not taught. Speaking and Listening is the exception: every standard is introduced. Coverage map ↗

9. **Language is thin even in our strongest grade.** Grade 2 Language is 31% in depth while every other Grade 2 ELA strand is 78% to 100%. Coverage map ↗

10. **Language holds many of the ELA standards not taught in their own grade.** Language has 43 of the 100 ELA standards rated not taught by their own grade, and 52 of the 174 that are only introduced. Gaps and repetition ↗

11. **Literacy is also taught through Science and Social Studies.** K-5 classes teach vocabulary, talk and non-fiction reading inside Science and Social Studies units, which the ELA ratings may not capture. (K-5 Science standards are 29% in depth and K-5 ELA standards 19%; the Science figure rates Science standards, not literacy.) Coverage map ↗

Essential Elements

Where much teaching may happen at the level students are at.

12. **Grade 3 may be teaching at the level students are at.** Grade 3 rated most of its Essential Elements in depth (Math 59%, ELA 66%) and rated none of its grade-level Math or ELA standards in depth. Grades 1 and 5 show the same pattern more mildly (Essential Elements 74% and 73% in depth against 21% and 24%; the Essential Elements are Math and ELA only, the main figures all four subjects). One reading: teams teach in depth at the level students are at, and kept "in depth" for the grade-level standard itself. Coverage map ↗

How we rated

Where the ratings may reflect how the scale was read.

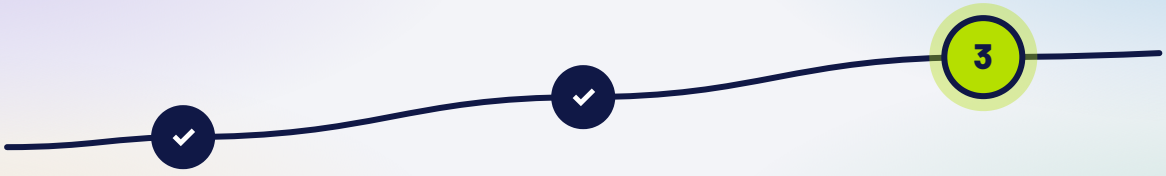
13. **Grade 2 and Grade 3 are 53 points apart.** That is the largest gap between neighbouring grades in the school. A gap this size is worth a conversation before either number is read as a measure of how much is taught. Gaps and repetition ↗

Choices and capacity

What a grade can carry in a year, and what we choose.

14. **Power standards are not yet our most secure.** In Social Studies, 68% of power standard ratings are not taught. In ELA, 18% are in depth. Priority and power (Audit) ↗

15. **Capacity shows what a K-5 grade carries in a year.** A K-5 grade takes about 25 standards to depth across its four subjects (about 6 per subject), introduces about 49 and does not teach about 43, out of about 117 rated. The range is wide, from 63 in depth in Grade 2 to 2 in Grade 3. By subject, per grade: ELA about 11 in depth of 57 rated, Math 8 of 29, Science 4 of 15, Social Studies 1 of 16. As shares of each subject's standards: ELA 19% in depth, 51% introduced, 29% not taught; Math 29% in depth, 36% introduced, 35% not taught; Science 29% in depth, 32% introduced, 39% not taught; Social Studies 6% in depth, 30% introduced, 64% not taught. Capacity here means what a grade currently reports taking to depth, introducing or not teaching in a year. It is not a target and not a judgement. Coverage map ↗



SECTION 3 OF 3

Moving forward

What you are seeing. Questions for teams to talk about. Each one shows the data that prompted it, and links to where that figure appears on this page.

What it adds to our story. K-5 sets up everything that follows, so these questions are about what every child carries into Grade 6.

Improving the curriculum

What to teach, deepen, place or leave out.

1. **Language has the most ELA standards never taken to depth: how could each grade take its own grammar, conventions and vocabulary standards to depth?**

   (Data: Language is 10% in depth in K-5, with 43 of the 100 ELA standards not taught in their own grade and 52 of the 174 introduced only) see Pattern 10

   Gaps and repetition ↗

2. **How can we embed Social Studies standards in the reading and writing we already teach in Grades 1 to 4?**

   (Data: No Social Studies standard rated in depth in Grades 1 to 4; not taught 57%, 74%, 89% and 73%) see Pattern 1

   Coverage map ↗

3. **Which K-5 Science and Social Studies units could also carry our ELA vocabulary and Language standards?**

   (Data: K-5 ELA Language is 10% in depth; K-5 Science is 29%) see Fact 4

   Coverage map ↗

4 How might Kindergarten's strength in talk become a bridge into Language, Reading and Writing?

(Data: Every Kindergarten Speaking and Listening standard is introduced, while Language is 93% not taught, Reading 78% and Writing 58%) see Fact 7

Coverage map ↗

5 Which K-5 standards could we agree to introduce only, or leave out, so the time goes to the ones we take to depth?

(Data: K-5 mix: 21% in depth, 42% introduced, 37% not taught) see Fact 11

Coverage map ↗

Working across grade levels

Grades and teams comparing and planning together.

6 What is Grade 2 doing that lets so much reach depth, and what could other grades borrow?

(Data: Grade 2 is 55% in depth: ELA 71%, Math 62%, Science 50%) see Fact 1

Coverage map ↗

Knowing the bands above and below

What the next grade or school relies on.

7 Fractions begin in Grade 3 and feed ratios and algebra: what would a Grade 3 to Grade 6 plan for fractions look like?

(Data: 0 of 30 fractions ratings in depth in Grades 3 to 5, 63% not taught; 19 fractions standards not taught in their own grade) see Fact 3

Gaps and repetition ↗

8 Which K-5 Physical Science ideas do Grade 8 and Grade 10 rely on, and how could the K-5 grades they belong to teach them?

(Data: 12 K-5 Physical Science standards are not taught in their own grade; 9 hand-over gaps on suggested links run from them into Grade 8 and Grade 10) see Fact 7

Progressions ↗

9 What would Grade 6 put on a one-page list of "what we hope students bring" in each subject?

(Data: Grade 5 to Grade 6 in depth: Math 32% to 0%, ELA 18% to 40%, Science 44% to 24%, Social Studies 10% to 6%) see Pattern 7

Coverage map ↗

10 Which 5 K-5 standards should every class in the next grade be able to rely on, and how would the next teacher know?

(Data: Depth moves 16%, 21%, 55%, 2%, 12%, 24% from Kindergarten to Grade 5; 222 K-5 standards are not taught in their own grade) see Pattern 3

Gaps and repetition ↗

11 Which K-5 standards do we most want every child to hold securely before Grade 6?

(Data: 222 K-5 standards are not taught in their own grade, and 34 hand-over gaps begin in K-5) see Fact 6

Progressions ↗

How we rate and plan

How we read the scale and plan our time.

12 Are our power standard lists the right size, and are they the standards we would protect if time ran short?

(Data: Across 415 power standard ratings, 20% in depth and 37% not taught; Kindergarten names 47 of its 57 ELA standards as power standards) see Fact 15

Priority and power (Audit) ↗

13 If Essential Elements are where much of our in-depth teaching sits, how do we plan from them up to the grade-level standard?

(Data: Math Essential Elements 82% in depth against 29% for Math standards; ELA 46% against 19%) see Fact 12

Coverage map ↗

14 What lies behind Grade 3's "not taught" ratings, and what is that teaching time used for (for example, Essential Elements)?

(Data: 63% not taught, including 31 of 32 Math standards; yet 59% of its Math and 66% of its ELA Essential Elements are in depth) see Fact 10

Grade 3 dashboard ↗

15 Knowing a K-5 grade takes about 25 standards to depth a year, which 25 should they be, and how should they be shared across the four subjects?

(Data: Per K-5 grade: about 25 in depth, 49 introduced, 43 not taught, out of 117 rated) see Pattern 15

Coverage map ↗

Our part in the story

What you are seeing. Options for what we could do, under four headings, each with the data behind it.

What it adds to our story. This is where findings turn into action: small, shared steps we could take together.

Options to discuss and act on. Pick what fits your team, change it, or add your own.

Improving the curriculum

In each K-5 grade, we could choose our 2 thinnest strands and plan one unit that takes them further.

(Data: Fractions 0% in depth; Language 10%; Social Studies 6%) see Fact 4

Coverage map ↗

Working across grade levels

We might ask Grade 2 to walk the K-5 team through how it plans a standard to depth, and Grade 3 to share what it teaches below grade level.

(Data: Grade 2 is 55% in depth; Grade 3 is 2%, yet 66% of its ELA Essential Elements are in depth) see Pattern 3

Coverage map ↗

Knowing the bands above and below

We could ask Grade 5 and Grade 6 to agree a one-page list per subject of what students should bring into middle school.

(Data: Grade 5 to Grade 6: Math 32% to 0%, ELA 18% to 40%, Science 44% to 24%) see Pattern 7

Coverage map ↗

A concrete action we could take

We might plan one fractions sequence from Grade 3 to Grade 6, with a shared check at the end of each year.

(Data: 0 of 30 fractions ratings in depth in Grades 3 to 5; 63% not taught) see Fact 3

Coverage map ↗

WHERE THE NUMBERS COME FROM AND HOW TO READ THEM

About the data

This paper walks through what our teachers reported about how our standards are taught, from Kindergarten to Grade 12. It has eight parts: the whole school, the three grade bands, and the four subjects. Each part has three sections: Facts, Patterns, and Moving forward (questions for teams to take forward, and options for our part in the story).

> **These findings come from the ratings you entered as teachers.** They show what teachers reported as taught across each grade, not what students know or can do. We are sharing them back so we can see the whole picture together and decide how we move forward. Each part ends with options for our part in the story. Every item links to the data on the Vertical Alignment site.

ABOUT THE DATA

How to read this paper

> **What you are seeing.** How the ratings were made, what the three ratings mean, and the words we use.
>
> **What it adds to our story.** It helps us read every number fairly: these are teachers' reports of teaching, not measures of what students know.

This paper walks through what our teachers reported about how our standards are taught, from Kindergarten to Grade 12. It has eight parts: the whole school, the three grade bands, and the four subjects. Each part has three sections: Facts, Patterns, and Moving forward (questions for teams to take forward, and options for our part in the story).

Where the numbers come from. Every figure is computed from the ratings sheet of 9 November 2026 (2,166 standards, 2,709 ratings, last rating 8 November) and checked against the Vertical Alignment reports and findings decks.

The three ratings.

Rating	What it means
Taught in depth	ALL classes in the grade consistently teach, reteach, review and assess the standard
Introduced / exposed	Anything in between: some classes, or taught briefly (for example, 3 of 5 classes)

Rating	What it means
Not taught	No class in the grade teaches it

Four things to hold in mind while reading.

- The ratings are what teachers reported as taught across a whole grade. They are not a measure of what students know or can do, and they do not judge any teacher.
- "In depth" is all or nothing. Teams may have read that more or less strictly, so a low figure can reflect a stricter reading, not less teaching. Where this matters most, the paper says so. Where a team rated none of its standards in depth, we read it as careful use of an all-or-nothing scale, not as an absence of teaching.
- Each team rated its own subject's standards. Much literacy (vocabulary, academic language, speaking, writing, reading non-fiction) is also taught through Science and Social Studies, and that teaching may not show in the ELA ratings.
- Shares are of the main grade-level ratings (one standard in one grade). Essential Elements (the alternate standards) are counted apart.

We cannot teach everything equally. No school can take every standard to depth, and that is not the goal. The goal is to choose on purpose: which standards we teach in depth, which we introduce, and which we leave out, and to plan that proportion together across the grades. The ratings show the mix we have now, so we can decide the mix we want.

Instructional capacity. How many standards a grade reports taking to depth, introducing or leaving out in a year, worked out from the ratings (the average for one grade). It is not a target and not a judgement: it describes the mix we report now, so we can decide together how to use it.

Categories. In every part, each section groups its items under the same categories, in the same order, so a team can follow one kind of observation across the whole school, its band and its subject. Facts: Bright spots, Gaps, Breadth without depth, Anomalies and Other notable. Patterns: Trends across the grades, Handoffs, Language and literacy, Essential Elements, How we rated, Choices and capacity, Toward the SAT and Other notable. Moving forward: Improving the curriculum, Working across grade levels, Knowing the bands above and below, and How we rate and plan. A category with nothing in it is left out.

How each part is laid out. Three sections, each opening with a small map that shows where you are: Facts, then Patterns, then Moving forward (questions to ponder, then options for our part in the story: improving the curriculum, working across grade levels, knowing the bands above and below, and a concrete action). Every pattern carries its figures in the text, and every question ends with the data behind it, in brackets and italics. The questions are invitations, not conclusions. Our strengths are named alongside the places where we might build.

ABOUT THE DATA

Method, sources and limits

> **What you are seeing.** How the ratings were made, what the three ratings mean, and the words we use.
>
> **What it adds to our story.** It helps us read every number fairly: these are teachers' reports of teaching, not measures of what students know.

Every figure in this paper was computed from the ratings sheet and cross-checked against the site. Where the site's band and K-12 views differ (progressions), the paper says which it uses. Percentages are rounded half up, as on the site.

What was read

Source	How it was used	How fully it was read
Ratings sheet, "All Standards and Ratings K-12" (9 Nov 2026)	Every figure	All 2,166 rows
Organized ratings workbook	Cross-check of totals	All tabs
20 Findings decks (band and subject)	Cross-check, questions and next-step themes	All slides and speaker notes
K-12 Reports PDF (118 pages)	Cross-check	First 80 pages scanned by search; a few read directly
7 other Reports PDFs	Cross-check of headline figures	Scanned by search, not read page by page

How terms are used

- **Rated standards.** One rating is one standard in one grade. A standard shared by several grades is counted once for each grade that rated it.
- **At least introduced.** Rated in depth or introduced.
- **Not taught where it belongs (confirmed).** The grade the standard belongs to rated it not taught (for a standard shared across grades, every grade that shares it did). In Math and ELA each standard belongs to one grade, so this means that grade's team rated it not taught; it does not mean other grades should have taught it.
- **Not taught where it fits.** Each standard was placed in the grade or course where it fits best, and that grade or course rated it not taught. Other grades were not asked to rate it.
- **Introduced, never in depth (met but not owned).** Introduced in at least one grade and in depth in none.
- **Progression finding.** An automatic check on a chain of linked standards: a step not taught, or a standard in depth while the one it builds on is not taught.

- **Taught at every step.** Every standard in the chain, across two or more grades, is at least introduced.
- **Progression.** A chain of linked standards across grades. Official links are the Coherence Map (Math), anchor standards (ELA) and the standards' own structure (Science, Social Studies). Other links are suggestions.
- **Instructional capacity.** The average number of standards one grade rated in depth, introduced and not taught in a year (all ratings divided by the number of grades), rounded.
- **Hand-over gap.** A standard taught in depth while a standard it builds on, placed in an earlier school, is rated not taught.
- **Priority and power standards.** Standards the school's own documents name: power standards in K-5, priority standards in 6-12.

Limits to keep in view

- Ratings are teachers' judgements of teaching across a grade. They are not observations and not student results.
- Grades may have read "in depth" differently. Uniform ratings across a whole grade are a reason to check how the scale was read; the paper points these out so teams can discuss them.
- The ratings are what teachers reported as taught. They do not measure what students know or can do.
- Each team rated its own subject. Literacy taught in Science and Social Studies, and Math taught in Science, may not show in the ELA and Math ratings.
- Middle school Science and high school Math, Science and Social Studies standards were placed in the grade or course where each fits best. 24 K-5 Social Studies standards are also rated not taught in the grade where they fit.
- Band counts of progressions look only at steps inside the band, so they do not add up to the K-12 figure.
- Literacy audit figures come from the 2026 PK-5 literacy audit of weekly plans.
- Some strands have few standards in a grade, so a single rating can move a percentage a long way. Counts are given where this matters.
- Suggested links between standards (most ELA, Science and Social Studies hand-overs) have not been checked by teachers.

Status. This is a draft for the Vertical Alignment Committee. Each finding should be checked with the teams concerned before it is treated as settled. The planned review of weekly and unit plans (Part 2) will test many of these patterns against what is actually planned.